The Iowa Wolves

Brand Audit and Analysis

Report By: Emily Hamling

PR/COMMUNICATIONS ASSETS

WEBSITE

URL

- https://iowa.gleague.nba.com/

Latest Organizational News

- "**Timberwolves Sign Jaylen Clark**"
  - The Minnesota Timberwolves announced the signing of Jaylen Clark, who had a standout season with the Iowa Wolves before his promotion to the NBA. Clark averaged 13.5 points, 5.0 rebounds, and 2.6 steals per game in the G League. *Published: February 27, 2025*
- "**Short-Handed Wolves Drop Series Finale to Clippers, 123 - 116**"
  - Despite injuries and limited roster depth, the Iowa Wolves fought hard but lost to the San Diego Clippers. The game featured a career-high performance from Will Baker and an almost triple-double from El Ellis. *Published: February 24, 2025*
- "**Clippers Take First Game over the Wolves, 117 - 108**"
  - The Wolves struggled to keep up in their first matchup with the San Diego Clippers. Skylar Mays led the team with a season-high 30 points, and Amari Bailey made his home debut following an ankle injury. *Published: February 23, 2025*

Website Analysis

- The Iowa Wolves' website is professionally designed, aligns with the NBA G League branding, and is easy to navigate.
- Strong visual elements include game highlights, team updates, and a direct link to ticket sales.
- Strengths:
  - Well-structured and organized sections, consistent throughout, frequent updates on team performance and player movements, and integration of multimedia content.
- Weaknesses:
  - Limited interactive content, lack of historical records of archives for stats and team history, little exclusive fan content.
- Areas for Growth & Recommendations:
  - Keep doing: Regular player updates, game recaps, and partnerships with the Timberwolves through hyperlinks (Timberwolves).
  - Stop doing: Heavy reliance on static press releases; need for dynamic, engaging content.
  - Start doing: Introduce fan engagement tools, exclusive behind-the-scenes content, and interactive features.

SOCIAL MEDIA AUDIT			
	Facebook	**X / Twitter**	**Instagram**
URL	Iowa Wolves Facebook	Iowa Wolves X/ Twitter	Iowa Wolves Instagram
# Fans/Followers	18K likes / 22K followers	21 K followers	35K followers
Hashtags	Little to no hashtags, primarily links	Little to no hashtags, primarily links	Little to no hashtags, primarily links
Primary Purpose	Inform and Engage	Inform and Engage	Engage and Entertain
Key Publics	Iowa basketball fans, local sports community, Timberwolves fans	Iowa basketball fans, NBA G League enthusiasts, Timberwolves fans	Basketball fans, young sports enthusiasts, Timberwolves fans
Brand Voice	Professional, energetic, community-driven	Fast-paced, engaging, competitive	High-energy, dynamic, visually appealing
Posting Frequency	4-5 posts per week	Multiple posts/ reposts daily	3-5 posts per week
Posting Times	Varies, often around game days and events	Real-time updates, often during games	Game days, significant announcements, high-engagement periods
Top Performing Content Types	Game highlights, player interviews, event promotions	Live game updates, highlights, player stats	Action shots, player features, reels, duo account posts
Top Content Themes	Game recaps, player news, promotions, community engagement	In-game updates, player performances, team promotions	Player-focused content, behind-the-scenes footage, fan interaction
Fan/Follower Engagement Level	Moderate	High, especially during games	High, with strong interaction on visuals
Organization/Team Engagement Level	Moderate	High (quick responses and updates)	High, frequent use of Stories, Reels, and captions to engage
Influencers	Timberwolves players/alums, local sports media	Timberwolves players, NBA G League reporters, local sports media	Players, team mascots, local basketball community, social media personalities, Timberwolves
Top Performing Posts	1- SIGNED – Player update 2- Fought until the very end – Game update 3- In the thick of it – Game update	1- SIGNED – Player update 2- Hockey is ABSURDDDDD – Team tweet 3- Jelly's first hockey game – Player content	1- Welcome to the squad – Duo post with Timberwolves 2- El Ellis was EVERYWHERE – Duo post with nbagleague 3- SIGNED – Player update
Sentiment	Generally positive, but fluctuates based on team performance	Mostly positive, with some neutral/negative sentiment after losses	Mostly positive, visually driven fan engagement

SOCIAL MEDIA ANALYSIS

Facebook

The Iowa Wolves' Facebook page is a hub for fan engagement, event promotions, and game recaps, catering to die-hard and casual fans. The team maintains a solid following with 18K likes and 22K followers, though engagement levels fluctuate based on content type and season timing.

Strengths:

- The page effectively promotes upcoming games, events, and community involvement, helping to boost attendance and ticket sales through hyperlinks (Iowa Wolves: Iowa Events Center). Player highlights and interviews, such as the recent feature on El Ellis, help create a connection between fans and the team. Posts about team history and accomplishments reinforce brand loyalty and credibility.

Areas for Improvement:

- More interactive content (e.g., polls, Q&A sessions, and behind-the-scenes footage) could increase fan engagement. Posting frequency is inconsistent; maintaining a steady flow of content—even during the offseason—could increase followers' feed visibility. The team could benefit from better use of Facebook Stories to provide real-time updates, quick news, and interactive elements like quizzes or countdowns.

Recommendations: Increase real-time engagement during games with live commentary, fan polls, and interactive Q&A. Utilize Facebook Stories and Reels to provide more frequent updates, especially behind-the-scenes content. Collaborate with local influencers or former players to create exclusive Facebook Live sessions, enhancing community engagement.

X / Twitter

Iowa Wolves' Twitter presence is highly active and engagement-driven, making it one of their most effective platforms. With 21K followers and a history of over 19K posts, the team uses Twitter effectively for real-time game updates, player highlights, and promotional content.

Strengths:

- Real-time updates keep fans informed during games, making it a go-to source for live stats and score tracking. The team interacts with fans, players, and media, maintaining a strong community presence. The casual and witty brand voice adds personality and relatability.

Areas for Improvement:

- While engagement is high during games, non-game-related content sometimes receives low interaction—more interactive offseason content is needed. Visual content could be enhanced with more GIFs, motion graphics, and fan polls to sustain interest. There is an opportunity to leverage player takeovers or fan Q&A sessions to further engagement.

Recommendations: Increase offseason engagement by posting historical highlights, offseason training clips, and throwback content. Use Twitter Spaces to host live discussions, potentially featuring players, coaches, or sports analysts. Run more fan-driven campaigns like "Pick the Play of the Week" or exclusive Twitter giveaways.

Instagram

The Iowa Wolves' Instagram account (35K followers) is their most visually engaging platform, leveraging high-quality images, game highlights, and promotional content. The platform's strength lies in its ability to tell stories through visuals, making it an excellent tool for brand-building and engagement. They post with other accounts through Instagram, helping generate likes and shares (Iowa Wolves on Instagram).

Strengths:

- Strong followers count relative to other platforms, demonstrating a high level of fan interest. Effective use of high-quality images and videos, especially game-day content and player spotlights. Consistent engagement on posts, particularly those featuring behind-the-scenes content, birthdays, and community outreach.

Areas for Improvement:

- The team could enhance its use of Instagram Stories and Reels to drive engagement further. There is room to experiment with interactive features like polls, countdowns, and live Q&A sessions to deepen fan interaction. More user-generated content (e.g., fan-submitted videos, "Wolves Fan of the Week") would create a more substantial community-driven presence.

Recommendations: Increase behind-the-scenes content, such as locker room footage, travel experiences, and day-in-the-life features of players. Utilize Instagram Reels more effectively to showcase highlight plays, fun player challenges, and interactive fan content. Introduce collaborations with local influencers or Minnesota Timberwolves players to enhance cross-promotion and increase exposure.

Overall

The Iowa Wolves have built a solid digital presence across Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram, with Twitter and Instagram being the most engagement-driven platforms. Each channel plays a distinct role in reaching its audience, but opportunities exist further to improve engagement, consistency, and fan involvement.

Key Takeaways: Twitter is the most decisive engagement platform due to its real-time game updates and direct fan interactions. However, offseason engagement needs improvement to maintain fan interest year-round. Instagram holds the highest follower count, showing its value as a visual brand-building tool, but it could use more Reels, behind-the-scenes content, and interactive features. Facebook is effective for general updates and event promotions, but engagement levels could be improved with more interactive content like live Q&A sessions and contests.

Overall Recommendations: Develop a cohesive content calendar that ensures consistent posting across all platforms, even in the offseason. Increase the use of video content (Reels, GIFs, live streams) across platforms to boost engagement and storytelling. Implement more fan-driven content, such as contests, polls, and user-generated content campaigns, to foster a deeper connection with the audience (Greenfly).

NEWS MONITORING

Media Coverage

- "**Miller with back-to-back 30 point games as SD Clippers take down Iowa Wolves**" – *The Sporting Tribune, Jared Knobloch.*
  - This article highlights the Iowa Wolves' recent 117-108 loss to the San Diego Clippers and how the Clippers' Jordan Miller dominated with 32 points. It discusses the Wolves' struggles with maintaining defensive consistency, despite a strong individual performance from Skylar Mays, who scored 30 points. The article also points out that San Diego controlled the game from start to finish.. *Published: February 23, 2025*
- "**Iowa Wolves' El Ellis eying his NBA shot after going undrafted**" – *KCCI, Jeff Dubrof.*
  - This feature story focuses on El Ellis, an undrafted guard playing for the Iowa Wolves, and his journey through the G-League as he works toward earning an NBA contract. It provides insight into how G-League players develop and prove themselves in hopes of landing an NBA deal. The article also sheds light on the player development system in the NBA G-League, showcasing Ellis' dedication and perseverance. *Published: February 24, 2025*
- "**What's Going On With the Iowa Wolves**" – *Canis Hoopus, Leo Sun.*
  - This in-depth analysis explores the Iowa Wolves' roster changes, struggles, and player development over the season. It details how key players such as Leonard Miller and Jaylen Clark were called up to the Minnesota Timberwolves, causing roster instability that contributed to the Wolves' 4-16 record heading into the All-Star break. The piece also highlights emerging prospects like Tristen Newton and Babacar Sané. *Published: February 14, 2025*

Brand Trends

- How would you characterize media coverage of your organization? Is the sentiment positive? negative? neutral?
  - The media coverage of the Iowa Wolves is primarily neutral to slightly negative due to the team's struggles in the standings. While player development and individual performances receive positive attention, the overall narrative is affected by the team's poor record and roster instability as players move between the G-League and the NBA.
- What event(s)/moment(s) could have prompted this sentiment? Summarize your findings in 25-50 words.
  - Negative sentiment stems from the team's losing record (4-19) and roster turnover, making it difficult to build consistency.
  - Neutral sentiment comes from game recaps and analyses focusing on statistics rather than emotional narratives.
  - Positive sentiment is found in player success stories, such as Jaylen Clark's call-up to the Timberwolves and El Ellis' journey from undrafted status to G-League success.

Industry News & Issues Management

- "**How Much Do G League Players Make?**"– *Sporting News, Rodney Reeves, February 20, 2025.*
  - This article examines the salaries of G League players, highlighting that most earn $40,500 per season, while two-way contract players make significantly more. This wage disparity presents challenges for player retention and career stability, impacting G League athletes, team executives, and agents navigating financial incentives and development pathways.
- "**NBA expansion hasn't happened for 20 years, so what does the future hold as league looks to grow to 32 teams?**" – *CBS Sports, Sam Quinn, November 4, 2024.*
  - With the NBA expected to expand to 32 teams, discussions around new franchises in Seattle and Las Vegas could impact G League teams like the Iowa Wolves by shifting affiliations, altering roster depth, or impacting financial allocations. Key publics affected include G League teams, front offices, and NBA organizations managing development pipelines.
- "**How a blind college student became a radio broadcaster for an NBA G League team**" – *CBS News, Steve Hartman, January 21, 2025.*
  - This article tells the inspiring story of a blind student broadcasting for a G League team, demonstrating the league's commitment to inclusivity and accessibility. While this is a positive PR moment for the G League, it also highlights the need for continued investment in accessibility and diversity initiatives. Key publics affected include sports media professionals, disability advocates, and G League teams looking to expand their inclusion efforts.

REFERENCES

Greenfly. (2023). Social Media in sports: Driving fan engagement. Retrieved from https://www.greenfly.com/blog/social-media-in-sports/

Iowa wolves on Instagram: “want to rock a Timberwolves-inspired statement edition jersey? head to iawolves.com/auction or the link in our bio for a chance to get your hands on one of our Timberwolves day specialty jerseys! bidding ends on Sunday, March 2nd at 10 pm.” (n.d.). Retrieved from https://www.instagram.com/p/DGlRISqqlW3/?hl=en&img_index=1

Iowa wolves: Iowa events center. (n.d.). Retrieved from https://hyveetix.evenue.net/events/NBDL

Timberwolves - the official site of the NBA for the latest NBA scores, Stats & News. (n.d.). Retrieved from https://www.nba.com/timberwolves/